Evan Borgstrom

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I'm a passionate technologist who fully embraces open-source and its ideologies. A leader and team builder that inspires and brings the best out in people. A hacker who is constantly striving for excellence. An engineer who is obsessed with automating any repeatable task.

I'm fascinated by how complex computer systems operate, and equally as fascinated with how businesses operate. I'm as comfortable talking with executives as I am talking with engineers.

Recent History

2022

Meta

From 2022 to 2024 I worked on Instagram Relevance & Machine Learning focused on management and optimization of models being used to power the Instagram app (Reels, Stories, Feed, etc).

From 2024 to 2025 I bootstrapped GenAI Production Engineering, scaling the team from 0 to 25 people in less than 12 months. We focused on Reliability within the product infrastructure as well as Large Language Model (LLM) inference.

In 2025 I shifted into a role focused on company wide reliability in training of ML/AI models.

2016

NerdWallet

Joined NerdWallet in the capacity of Principal Engineer to build a highly scalable software delivery pipeline, based on immutable and ephemeral run time (a la containers), with infrastructure defined via code, and presented as a cohesive platform to our Engineering teams.

2014

LinkedIn

Relocated to San Francisco to join LinkedIn in their Site Reliability Engineering group. Focused on automation at the scale of tens of thousands, and driving change to build more efficient systems for running a large, massively distributed set of service oriented applications.

2012

Art + Technology

My interest in hardware hacking led me to collaborate with some amazing artists on a number of art projects that were built upon a technology foundation.

The Knitter Stream is a hacked knitting machine that knits tweets from Twitter. It was built for the C2MTL conference. Full source is available on GitHub. (Arduino + Python)

The Mood Mixer was a project built using OSC and Max MSP with Ableton Live to create user generated sound and visuals. It lived at the 2012 Luminato Festival in Toronto. (Max MSP + Python).

2009

Focusing on automation

Led the design and development of systems to automate the provisioning, management and trouble response within a virtualized environment (Xen, then KVM) for the purpose of hosting web sites & applications. Created a custom "private cloud" on top of leading open source automation tools.

2007

FatBox Founded

Founded and built a Managed Services company focused on providing technology solutions to the creative services industry.

Built relationships with some of Toronto's most awarded creative agencies, providing all infrastructure required for digital projects.

2000

UUNet / MCI / Verizon Business

Held a variety of roles ranging from CTAC to Sr. UNIX Admin to System Architect. Consistently met and exceeded KPI for growth in all roles and was frequently recognized by peers through company programs.

1990's

Mac SE, Tandy, Commodore 64, DOS, Basic, FreeBSD, Linux, Networking, Perl

An obsession begins...

Skill Highlights

Open Source

Avidly contributing to Open Source since 2002. Original author of the Qmail Qregex patch. Author of numerous Python & Django packages available on PyPI. Evangelist and contributor to SaltStack since 2012.

Programming

Avid programmer interested in all languages & platforms. Currently loving Python and very interested in Go. Previous experience with Javascript, Perl, Bash, Ruby, C and PHP.

Markup

Proficient in many structured markup languages: HTML, XML (yuck), CSS, Sassy CSS, YAML, JSON, Restructured Text, Markdown, LaTeX.

Operating Systems

Linux administrator since 1998. Expert Debian & CentOS skills. Have run Solaris since version 6. Previously ran both FreeBSD, OpenBSD & Gentoo in production. Expert understanding of very low level operating system concepts with the ability to troubleshoot and debug any issue that may arise.

Networking

Experience managing both corporate, access & transit networks. Comfortable administrating Cisco, Juniper & Force10 devices. Working knowledge of many of protocols. Comfortable both reading & interpreting as well as authoring & contributing to RFC documents.

Personality

Calm and collected, able to operate under high pressure situations as well as within tight project constraints. I highly value intelligence and love having my opinion altered by a logical presentation of an alternate opinion.

Language

Strong written & verbal English skills. Basic verbal French skills.